

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DEED

Date: 5/14/2026

Bill Number: SB 143

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): MUNI SCHOOL BOARD TERMS; CITY COUNCILS

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☐ SIGN ☐ VETO ☒ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

SB143 makes targeted adjustments to local governance structures that have minimal direct impact on the Department of Education and Early Development's statewide operations. The changes primarily affect how municipalities and small communities structure their school board terms and city councils, rather than altering instructional policy, program requirements, or departmental responsibilities. As such, the bill does not create new mandates for the department, nor does it require new resources, regulatory action, or significant administrative changes.

At the same time, the bill contains provisions that may benefit local governments by offering greater flexibility in determining school board term lengths and aligning elections with broader electoral cycles, which can reduce administrative and cost burdens at the local level. It also provides small communities with options for appropriately sizing their city councils, which may support local governance stability in areas that historically face recruitment challenges.

Because SB143 delivers these limited but practical local governance adjustments, and because the bill does not significantly affect departmental operations, the department remains neutral. A

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recommendation to allow the bill to become law without signature reflects this neutrality: the bill presents no operational concerns for the department, contains modest governance improvements for communities, and does not necessitate an affirmative endorsement.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

This bill provides additional guidance regarding how the terms of office of school board members can be changed. It also provides an option for exceptions regarding the election of school board members. Finally, the governing body of the municipality may alter the terms of office by ordinance.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1: Amenda AS 14.12.050 by adding a new subsection (d) stating that the governing body of a municipality may alter the terms of the office provided by in this section.

Section 2: Amends AS 29.20.300(a) by adding subsection (c) as an alternative exception for each municipal school with regards to their school board.

Section 3: Amends AS 29.300 by adding a new subsection (c) allowing the governing body of a municipality alter the terms of the office provided for in (a) of this section by ordinance.

Section 4: This Act takes effect immediately under AS 01.070(c).

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

None

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

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Support:

- George Hays, Deputy Borough Manager, Matanuska-Susitna Borough, Palmer, Alaska, testified in support of SB 143.
- Katherine Gardner, Deputy Superintendent, Matanuska-Susitna Borough School District, Palmer, Alaska, testified by invitation on SB 143.
- Lon Garrison, Executive Director, Association of Alaska School Boards (AASB), testified in support of CSSB 143(CRA).

Opposition:

- No formal opposition testimony was identified in the committee record.

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

No recommendations.

Commissioner's Signature: _____



Date: 5.14.2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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